



APPLICATION FOR IRB REVIEW OF NEW RESEARCH INVOLVING HUMAN SUBJECTS

Complete the following form and upload this document to the online IRB system in Mentor. In addition to this application, you will also need to upload any survey/interview questions and informed consent documents for your protocol.

1. RESEARCH PROJECT DESCRIPTION

Provide, in lay terms, a detailed summary of your proposed study by addressing each of the following items:

Clearly state the purpose of the study (Usually this will include the research hypothesis)

The purpose of the study is to assess the effects of birth order, immigration background, and gender on mental well-being in adults.

H1: Overall, first-borns will report lower mental well-being than later-borns.

H2: First-borns with immigrant backgrounds will report lower mental well-being than later-borns.

H3: Immigration background and gender moderate the negative effect of birth order on mental well-being; first-born daughters with immigrant backgrounds will report the lowest mental well-being out of all groups.

Background (Describe past studies and any relevant experimental or clinical findings that led to the plan for this project) Previous research has shown that first-borns experience lower mental well-being than later-borns. Fullerton et al. (1989) found that male first-borns scored higher on the negative feelings subscale of psychological well-being than other-borns when controlling for socioeconomic status, which correlates with psychiatric symptoms. In a study of 3,744 Japanese children, later-borns exhibited higher prosocial behavior and resilience while displaying fewer total difficulties, conduct problems, and hyperactivity than first-borns (Fukuya et al., 2021). Lawson & Mace (2010) supported this finding in British children—the presence of older siblings predicted higher childhood mental health, while the arrival of younger siblings indicated increased emotional and conduct difficulties.

Immigration background may also play a role in mental well-being. Although many immigrants experience a healthy migrant effect where foreign-born people seem healthier than native-born people (Ali, 2002), that effect may be due to selection bias or cultural stigma. Immigration remains a stressful process, especially for women (Furnham & Bochner, 1986). The immigration paradox describes how mental health issues arise more commonly in second- and third-generation immigrants (Alegria et al., 2017).

Gender may also be a factor as women tend to report more psychiatric symptoms than men (Johns Hopkins Medicine, 2024). Kern et al. (2020) tested the multiple jeopardy hypothesis, which predicts that the negative effect of being a member of multiple marginalized social groups is higher than the additive negative effect of all those social groups (King, 1998). This hypothesis was tested with the factors of socioeconomic status, immigration background, and gender on mental well-being, and resulted in additive rather than interactive effects (Kern et al., 2020).

This study aims to test the multiple jeopardy hypothesis with the factors of birth order, immigration background, and gender on mental well-being. It also aims to replicate the effect of birth order on mental well-being and explore the different subscales of mental well-being that are affected by it.

Research plan (Provide an orderly scientific description of the intended methodology and procedures as they directly affect the subjects)

1. Participants will fill out the online consent form.
2. Participants will fill out the 42-item, 7-point Ryff Psychological Well-Being Scale (Ryff, 1989).
3. Participants will fill out the Patient Health Questionnaire (PHQ-9) (Kroenke et al., 2001). Question 9 on suicidal ideation has been taken out.
4. Participants will fill out the Generalized Anxiety Disorder Scale (GAD-7) (Spitzer et al., 2006).
5. Participants will fill out a demographic questionnaire. They will also be asked about their immigration background and birth order.
6. Participants will conclude the online survey and be debriefed.

Give the location(s) the study will take place (institution, city, state, and specific location)

This study will have no specific location and will be conducted online with the Qualtrics survey tool.

Duration of study project

The study will be active for one semester starting with the Fall of 2024.

2. PARTICIPANTS

2(a) Participant Population and Recruitment

Describe who will be included in the study as participants and any inclusion and exclusion criteria.

Participants will be students enrolled at the University of San Francisco.

What is the intended age range of participants in the study?

The intended age range of participants in the study is 17-30 years old. However, all adults are allowed to participate.

Describe how participant recruitment will be performed.

Most participants will be undergraduate students who are enrolled in the General Psychology (PSYC 101) classes in Fall 2024. Students will participate in the experiment as part of a class requirement in which they must complete participation hours in USF research studies or by writing a research paper. By completing this experiment, participants will earn one half hour of credit for the research participation option.

Additional participants will be recruited through a text flyer advertised through student organizations at USF.

Do the forms of advertisement for recruitment contain only the title, purpose of the study, protocol summary, basic eligibility criteria, study site location(s), and how to contact the study site for further information? ☒ Yes ☐ No

*If you answered "no," the forms of advertisement must be submitted to and approved by the IRB prior to their use.

2(b) Participant Risks and Benefits

What are the benefits to participants in this study?

There are no direct benefits related to this study.

What are the risks (physical, social, psychological, legal, economic) to participants in this study?

There are no direct risks related to this study.

If deception is involved, please explain.

N/A

Indicate the degree of risk (physical, social, psychological, legal, economic) you believe the research poses to human subjects (*check **the one** that applies*).

☒ **MINIMAL RISK:** A risk is minimal where the probability and magnitude of harm or discomfort anticipated in the proposed research are not greater, in and of themselves, than those ordinarily encountered in daily life or during the performance of routine physical or psychological examinations or tests.

☐ **GREATER THAN MINIMAL RISK:** Greater than minimal risk is greater than minimal where the probability and magnitude of harm or discomfort anticipated in the proposed research are greater than those ordinarily encountered in daily life or during the performance of routine physical or psychological examinations or tests. **If you checked "Greater than Minimal Risk", provide a statement about the statistical power of the study based on intended sample size, design, etc. to test the major hypotheses)**

2(c) Participant Compensation and Costs

Are participants to be financially compensated for the study? ☐ Yes ☒ No If "yes," indicate amount, type, and source of funds.

Amount:

Source:

Type (e.g., gift card, cash, etc.):

Will participants who are students be offered class credit? ☒ Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A

If you plan to offer course credit for participation, please describe what alternative assignment(s) students may complete to get an equal amount of credit should they choose not to participate in the study.

Students will participate in the experiment as part of a class requirement in which they must complete participation hours in on-campus research projects or by writing a research paper. By completing this experiment, participants will earn one half hour of credit for the research participation option. The alternative option is for the students to write a research paper.

Are other inducements planned to recruit participants? ☐ Yes ☒ No If yes, please describe.

3. CONFIDENTIALITY AND DATA SECURITY

Will personal identifiers be collected (e.g., name, social security number, license number, phone number, email address, photograph)? ☐ Yes ☒ No

Will identifiers be translated to a code? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Describe how you will protect participant confidentiality and secure research documents, recordings (audio, video, photos), specimens, and other records.

Any potential identifiers (e.g. timestamps) linked to participants' responses will be destroyed after data collection ends in December 2024.

During data analyses, the subject data will be kept separate from subject identity. Subject identification will be destroyed after names are recorded in the SONA system and the participant has been allocated their class credit.

4. CONSENT

4a. Informed consent

Do you plan to use a written consent form that the participant reads and signs? ☒ Yes ☐ No

***If "no," you must complete Section 4b or 4c below.**

If "yes," describe how consent will be obtained and by whom.

Participants will read an online consent form before continuing the rest of the survey.

If the participants are minors under the age of 18 years, will assent forms be used? ☒ Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A

If "no," please explain.

Consent will be obtained from minors' parents at the start of the semester, allowing participants to partake in any study offered to PSYC 101 General Psychology students moving forward, considering they give their own consent. In addition, participants under 18 will be shown an older child assent form in addition to the regular consent form before continuing with the survey. Upon request, parents/guardians can receive a parent consent form specific to the study.

Upload to the online IRB system the consent form(s) that the participants and/or parent/guardian will be required to sign, and the assent forms for children under the age of 18, if applicable.

Note: All consent forms must contain the following elements (quoted directly from Office for Human Research Protections regulations, available at: <http://www.hhs.gov/ohrp/humansubjects/guidance/45cfr46.htm#46.116>. The University of San Francisco IRB has consent templates containing all required elements, **and we strongly recommend you use these templates.**

If you believe it is important to create your own consent form, you are free to do so but please ensure that your consent form has each of the following elements and indicate you have done so by checking this box:

☐ I have chosen to create my own consent form and have ensured that it contains the 8 essential elements listed below:

(1a) A statement that the study involves research, (1b) an explanation of the purposes of the research, (1c) the expected duration of the subject's participation, (1d) a description of the procedures to be followed, and (1e) identification of any procedures which are experimental;

(2) A description of any reasonably foreseeable risks or discomforts to the subject;

(3) A description of any benefits to the subject or to others which may reasonably be expected from the research;

(4) A disclosure of appropriate alternative procedures or courses of treatment, if any, that might be advantageous to the subject;

(5) A statement describing the extent, if any, to which confidentiality of records identifying the subject will be maintained;

(6) For research involving more than minimal risk, an explanation as to whether any compensation and an explanation as to whether any medical treatments are available if injury occurs and, if so, what they consist of, or where further information may be obtained;

(7) An explanation of whom to contact for answers to pertinent questions about the research and research subjects' rights, and whom to contact in the event of a research-related injury to the subject; and

(8) A statement that participation is voluntary, refusal to participate will involve no penalty or loss of benefits to which the subject is otherwise entitled, and the subject may discontinue participation at any time without penalty or loss of benefits to which the subject is otherwise entitled."

4b. Waiver of documentation of written informed consent (Complete only if answered "no" to 4a)

The regulations allow instances in which the IRB may waive the requirement for documentation of informed consent, that is, the collection of a signed consent form. If you are requesting a waiver of written documentation (signed) of informed consent, please answer the following questions:

Will the only record linking the participant and the research be the consent document and the principal risk to the participant would be from breach of confidentiality? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Do you consider this a minimal risk study that involves no procedures for which written consent is normally required outside of research (see 2B above for definition)? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Explain why you are requesting waiver or modification of documentation of written (signed) informed consent and how you plan to obtain consent.

4c. Waiver or modification of informed consent (Complete only if answered "no" to 4a)

The regulations also provide an opportunity for the IRB to waive the requirement for informed consent or to modify the informed consent process, provided the protocol meets the following criteria:

- (1) The research involves no more than minimal risk to subjects (see 2b above for definition);
- (2) The waiver or alteration will not adversely affect the rights and welfare of the subjects;
- (3) The research could not practicably be carried out without the waiver or alteration; and
- (4) Whenever appropriate, the subjects will be provided with additional pertinent information after participation.

If you are requesting a waiver or modification of informed consent (e.g., incomplete disclosure, deception), explain how your project meets the requirements for waiver or modification of informed consent, as outlined above.

Consent Form

Parent Consent Form

Assent Form

Gen Psych Overall Parent Consent Form

Survey

Debrief